

Gotta install 'em all

They say that there's an app for everything. And it's true to a large extent. Apps have been around right from where computers with user interfaces came into existence. Even back when computers didn't have graphical user interfaces (GUI), programming was done by the use of punch cards. In a way, those punch cards were the earliest progenitors of modern-day apps. Then came user interfaces with archaic operating systems and programmers were hired to explicitly build apps by the companies buying computers. As GUI became commonplace, the operating system changed and the need for extending the capabilities of computers continued to grow. Every company investing in computers wanted a slight modification in the way things were done. And manufacturers were more than happy to incorporate these modifications. At least, the common ones. And it wasn't long before a few enterprising programmers realised that they could make a living off of programming applications. We now have applications for Linux, Windows, macOS, Android, iOS and even web apps, which have become really feature-rich over the last decade.

Now we all have our own collection of must-have applications for the platforms that we use as our daily drivers. These are apps that we simply can not live without. Those of you who have been using our DVDs and e-DVDs over the last two decades should be familiar with the "Essentials" that we include each month. This booklet is not going to be that.